

Catherine's Catering

Problem Definition

Catherine's Catering is experiencing problems with handling the number of routine calls with customers, as well as coordinating with external partners such as suppliers and meeting facilities. The growth in the number of part-time staff is leading to scheduling conflicts and understaffed events.

Issues	Weight
1. Customer contact takes an inordinate amount of time for routine questions.	10
2. Managing part-time employees is time consuming and leads to scheduling errors.	9
3. It is difficult to accommodate last-minute changes for events.	7
4. Supplies are ordered for each event. Often shipments are received several times a day.	6
5. There are often problems communicating changes to event facilities.	5
6. There is little historical information about customers and meals.	3

Objectives

1. Provide a web system for customers to obtain pricing information and place orders.
2. Create or purchase a human resources system with a scheduling component.
3. After customers have signed an event contract, provide them with Web access to their account and a means for them to update the number of guests. Notify management of changes.
4. Provide a means to determine overall quantities of supplies for events occurring with a concurrent time frame.
5. Provide a system for communicating changes to key personnel at event facilities.
6. Store all event data and make summary informationn available in a variety of formats.

Requirements

1. The system must be secure.
2. Feedback must be entered by event manager at the close of each event.
3. There must be a means for event facilities to change their contact person.
4. The system must be easy to use by nontechnical people.

Constraints

1. Development costs must not exceed \$50,000.
2. The initial website for customer orders must be ready by March 1 to accommodate requests for graduation parties and weddings.